

Chapter 14: Project Toolkit — Phase 1

Drafting Core Documents for Data Collection

Gordon Wright

1 Overview

This lab is **Phase 1** of the Project Toolkit. You will draft the core documents your group needs before data collection day. **Labs 17 and 18** complete all toolkit materials so you are ready for **data collection in Week 19**.

Phase 1 (Week 17): Draft Participant Information Sheet, Consent Form, Debrief Form, Participant Instructions, and **start** the Researcher Procedure.

Phase 2 (Week 18): Recruitment Script, Data Recording Sheet, finalise Stimulus Materials, **complete** Researcher Procedure, practice run, Research Study Order Form.

2 Why These Documents Matter

Your group must prepare **9 documents** (see the Project Toolkit checklist). In Phase 1 you focus on the **participant-facing** documents and the beginning of the **Researcher Procedure**. These ensure:

- **Ethics:** Informed consent (Information Sheet + Consent) and debriefing (Debrief Form) are required.
 - **Standardisation:** Participant Instructions and Researcher Procedure ensure every participant is treated the same way.
 - **Replicability:** A clear procedure allows others (and your future selves) to run the study exactly the same way.
-

3 Document 1: Participant Information Sheet

What it is: A formal document given to potential participants *before* they agree. It explains the study in general terms so they can give informed consent.

Who sees it: Every participant; they read it before signing consent and keep a copy.

Tips:

- Describe **purpose** and **what will happen** in plain language. Do **not** reveal your hypothesis.

- Include: time required, risks/benefits, confidentiality, right to withdraw, contact for questions.
 - Use the toolkit template and customise the purpose and “what will happen” sections. Refer to the worked example for tone and length.
-

4 Document 2: Consent Form

What it is: The form the participant signs to confirm they have read the information, understand the study, and agree to take part. A legal and ethical requirement.

Who sees it: Every participant signs one; you keep the signed copies securely.

Tips:

- Update the **study title** only if needed; the checklist items are standard.
 - Use the **same study title** on every document (Information Sheet, Consent, Debrief, Procedure).
 - Plan to print plenty of copies (e.g. 30) for data collection.
-

5 Document 3: Debrief Form

What it is: A document given to participants *after* the study explaining its true purpose, including the hypothesis and relevant theory.

Who sees it: Every participant receives this after completing the study.

Tips:

- Here you **can** (and should) reveal the hypothesis and explain the theory (e.g. dual coding, anchoring).
 - Include data withdrawal instructions and support service contacts.
 - Keep it to about one page. Use the template and worked example.
-

6 Document 7: Participant Instructions

What it is: A clear, step-by-step sheet telling the participant exactly what to do during the study (e.g. “Read the list of words”, “You have 2 minutes”, “Write down as many as you can remember”).

Who sees it: Every participant reads this before the study begins.

Tips:

- Use **numbered steps** and plain language. No jargon; no hypothesis.
- Keep it short (about half a page). If your between- and within-subjects procedures differ, use separate instruction sheets.
- Do **not** reveal what you expect to find.

7 Document 8: Researcher Procedure (Start in Phase 1)

What it is: A detailed step-by-step guide for the researcher running the study. Includes exact wording, timing, and the full procedure. Your “recipe” for running the study.

Who sees it: Researchers only.

Tips:

- **Phase 1:** Write the materials checklist, the sequence (greeting → consent → instructions → main task → debrief), timing for each phase, and exact words to say to participants (in quotes or italics).
 - **Phase 2 (Week 18):** Complete with data recording, scoring, and any final details. Any group member should be able to run the study from this document alone.
 - Use the template; refer to the between- or within-subjects example procedure in the toolkit.
-

8 Preparation for the Lab

Before the lab:

- Re-read the Project Toolkit timeline and document checklist (documents 1, 2, 3, 7, 8).
 - Have your **research question, design** (between/within), and **main task** (what participants do) clear from your Research Plan.
 - Download the relevant **templates** from the toolkit so you can start drafting in the lab.
-

9 Summary

Document		Phase 1 action
1. Participant Information Sheet		Draft (purpose, what happens, no hypothesis)
2. Consent Form		Draft (study title consistent)
3. Debrief Form		Draft (hypothesis + theory + withdrawal/support)
7. Participant Instructions		Draft (numbered steps, no hypothesis)
8. Researcher Procedure		Start (checklist, sequence, timing, script); complete in Week 18

All templates and the worked example are in the Project Toolkit.